it also retained a greater militant infrastructure. Under US pressure the ISI reportedly closed down many of the training camps in Pakistan-administered Kashmir in 2003, though some of them were relocated elsewhere. Lashkar was the only outfit operating large, territorially-rooted camps in Pakistan-administered Kashmir by 2004.[27]

Most of the militants not allowed to fight in Indian-administered Kashmir were confined to their camps, but rather than remain idle many joined splinter groups or began freelancing. Some of them began making their way to North and South Waziristan in FATA to link up with al-Qaeda and the Taliban, which were regrouping there. This accelerated the process of fragmentation and decentralization among the Deobandi groups that began after 9/11. Over time, their group names—JeM, HuM, HuJI and LeJ—came to mean less from an organizational perspective. These names maintained utility as identity-markers and alerted others to a person's background, but stating someone was from JeM no longer meant he necessarily belonged to the group. This phenomenon was less pronounced for Lashkar. As many interlocutors pointed out, its name still meant something in the way that those of the Deobandi groups no longer did by the middle of the decade.

Lashkar did split briefly in spring 2004, though not because of disagreements over policy as happened with the Deobandi outfits. Rather, the issue was Hafiz Saeed's nepotism, specifically accusations that he was selectively promoting members of his Gujjar caste. Tension over how money was being distributed also factored in the dispute. When Saeed married a woman thirty years his junior who was the widow of a Lashkar martyr, Zafar Iqbal and other members of the leadership council objected, suggesting it was unsuitable for the head of the organization.[28] Iqbal was one of the initial founders of the organization and viewed himself as Saeed's equal. Friction between them was nothing new and Saeed responded by criticizing Iqbal's second marriage to a young Baltistani girl.[29] Tensions escalated and several top leaders, including Iqbal and Lakhvi, split to form Khairun Naas [People's Welfare] taking some of Lashkar's senior commanders with them.[30] Because the heads of the Al-Dawa Schools, seminaries, hospitals, and health centers had joined Khairun Naas, the new organization laid claim to all of those institutions. Lakhvi also claimed the centre at Muridke because of his familial relation to Abdur